

Computer programming

CSC103 Programming Fundamentals / Lecture 01

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The problem for this lecture

Write pseudocode for converting hours and minutes into total minutes. Trace 2 hours 35 minutes and 0 hours 0 minutes.

Accept nonnegative hours and minutes in 0..59.

Learning objectives

- Explain how a program solves a problem
- Describe structured, object-oriented and functional approaches
- Write and trace a finite algorithm

CLO-1

Programs and algorithms

Input, processing and output

Programming paradigms

Problem-solving workflow

Programs and algorithms

- A program expresses instructions in a programming language.
- An algorithm gives precise steps for a task and must terminate for its intended inputs.

Example

Task: calculate the cost of 3 notebooks at Rs 120 each.

Inputs: quantity, unit price

Process: multiply

Output: Rs 360

Input, processing and output

- Inputs represent the information a problem supplies.
- Processing transforms that information. Outputs answer the original question.

Example

```
READ quantity
READ unitPrice
total = quantity * unitPrice
DISPLAY total
```

Programming paradigms

- Structured programming organises sequence, selection and repetition.
- Object-oriented programming groups state and behaviour in objects.
- Functional programming emphasises computing results from functions.

Example

Structured: calculate a bill step by step.

Object-oriented: a Cart holds items and calculates its total.

Functional: calculate a `new` total from supplied prices.

Problem-solving workflow

- State the required result and input constraints before coding.
- Work a small example manually, write an algorithm, then test the implementation.

Example

Requirement: average two marks in 0..100.

Example: 60 and 80 gives 70.

Boundary: 0 and 100 gives 50.

Precision in an algorithm

- A computer follows the stated rule even when the rule is unsuitable.
- An instruction such as "calculate the time" leaves the units and formula unspecified.
- A useful algorithm defines input, calculation and output precisely.

Example

Ambiguous: convert the time.

Precise: multiply hours by 60, then add minutes.

Testing the model before coding

- A manually solved case checks whether the formula represents the task.
- A zero case checks that the algorithm behaves sensibly at the smallest allowed input.
- Invalid inputs require a stated response before implementation.

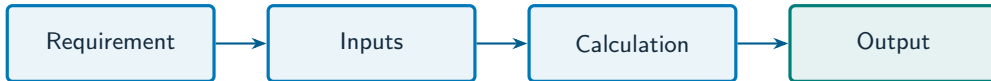
Example

`2 h 35 min = 120 + 35 = 155 min`

`0 h 0 min = 0 min`

`2 h 75 min violates the stated minute range.`

From a requirement to a result



What to notice

A useful algorithm makes the meaning and units of every stage explicit.

Key distinctions

Approach	Main organising idea	Example in a billing program
Structured	Ordered steps and control flow	Read items, calculate, print
Object-oriented	Objects with state and behaviour	A Cart calculates its total
Functional	Functions transform inputs	A function returns a total

These distinctions determine which operation or control structure fits the problem.

First example: execution

```
int quantity = 3;  
int unitPrice = 120;  
int total = quantity * unitPrice;  
System.out.println(total);
```

First example: result

360

quantity=3 and unitPrice=120 remain unchanged.
total receives the product 360.

Programming paradigms
Problem-solving workflow

Guided practice

Write pseudocode for converting hours and minutes into total minutes. Trace 2 hours 35 minutes and 0 hours 0 minutes.

Attempt the solution before continuing.
Use the definitions and examples from this lecture.

Solution strategy

- Accept nonnegative hours and minutes in 0..59.
- Convert only the hours to minutes using $\text{hours} * 60$.
- Add the remaining minutes and label the output unit.

The next program uses fixed inputs so its result can be reproduced.

Complete solution

```
public class Solution01 {  
    public static void main(String[] args) throws Exception {  
        int hours = 2;  
        int minutes = 35;  
        int totalMinutes = hours * 60 + minutes;  
        System.out.println(totalMinutes + " minutes");  
    }  
}
```


Execution trace

Step	Expression	Value
Read hours	hours	2
Read minutes	minutes	35
Convert hours	hours * 60	120
Combine	120 + 35	155
Report	totalMinutes	155 minutes

Follow the changing state in execution order.

Solution result

155 minutes

Why this result follows
Add the remaining minutes and label
the output unit.

A common incorrect approach

A student calculates $\text{totalMinutes} = \text{hours} + \text{minutes} * 60$. Use 2 hours 35 minutes to explain the error.

Example

The formula gives 2102. Hours require multiplication by 60. Correct result: 155.

Boundary and failure checks

Check the stated input assumptions.

Write an algorithm for a rectangle perimeter. Give normal, zero-size and invalid-input examples.

READ hours, minutes

$\text{totalMinutes} = \text{hours} * 60 + \text{minutes}$

DISPLAY totalMinutes

Results: 155 and 0. Assume nonnegative hours and minutes in 0..59.

Check your understanding

How does an algorithm differ from a program? Why is a single successful test insufficient?

Write a prediction and explain the rule that supports it.

Answer and explanation

An algorithm describes a procedure. A program implements instructions in a language. One test covers only one selected case.

The formula gives 2102. Hours require multiplication by 60. Correct result: 155.

Compare cases and predict outcomes

Case	Inputs	Expected area
Ordinary rectangle	width 8, height 3	24 square units
Zero width	width 0, height 3	0 square units
Outside the domain	width -2, height 3	Reject negative length

Discuss

Explain each expected result before running the example. Which case would reveal a wrong assumption?

Apply the idea

Independent practice

Design pseudocode for rectangle area. Reject a negative side; allow a zero side. Trace (8,3), (0,3), and (-2,3).

1. Work through the input by hand.
2. Write or correct the program.
3. Justify the expected result.

Solution and reasoning

```
READ width, height
IF width < 0 OR height < 0
    PRINT "Invalid length"
ELSE
    PRINT width * height
```

- Validate before calculating; a negative area would misrepresent the stated model.
- Multiplication gives 24 and 0 for the two valid cases.
- The invalid case produces a message instead of a numeric area.

Lecture summary

- how a program solves a problem
 - structured, object-oriented and functional approaches
 - and trace a finite algorithm
- Accept nonnegative hours and minutes in 0..59.
 - Convert only the hours to minutes using $\text{hours} * 60$.
 - Add the remaining minutes and label the output unit.

After-class practice

Write an algorithm for a rectangle perimeter. Give normal, zero-size and invalid-input examples.

Syllabus reading

Deitel Ch 1

Next lecture: Source files and execution